

Assignment Name: Chapter 3, Mastery 1 (Exercise 5)

Understanding the Problem:

1. How did you approach understanding the challenge?
I read it
2. Were there any parts of the problem that you found confusing at first? If so, how did you resolve the confusion?
None

Planning the Solution:

1. Did you create a plan or break the problem into smaller steps before coding?

Yes, I broke the problem into creating the vertical segments, the horizontal segments, and the x in the center.
2. How did you decide on which tools, algorithms, and data structures to use?

I decided on using functions since it'd be the easiest to read and fun to make.

Implementation:

1. Did you write the code in smaller pieces or attempt the entire solution at once?

I wrote the code in smaller pieces.
2. How did you test your solution to ensure that it was working correctly?

I ran the code I just used to ensure that it worked properly.

Overcoming Challenges:

1. What part of the problem was the most difficult for you?

The hardest part was figuring out how to implement optional arguments. Unlike Python, Java doesn't have a direct feature for optional arguments so I had to make a workaround with two functions with the same name. The other function has the conditional argument. The original function calls the other function with the default argument. This makes calling the argument optional.

2. How did you handle moments where you felt stuck or unsure what to do next?

There was an issue with one of my if conditionals to print the center X. I felt stuck since java was giving an error for the statement when I thought something was wrong with the first expression I coded. I solved this by asking ChatGPT what the issue was.

Learning:

1. Was there anything that you learned that you think will help you with future challenges?

Learning how to implement optional arguments into functions will facilitate other processes in the future. I also learned how Java errors can be imprecise, they can be misleading if you haven't seen them before.